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Attachments

Public Comment for AI Action Plan - Gemino Cortez

Chief Information Officers Council (CIOC) Innovation Committee

March 2025

PUBLIC COMMENT FOR THE DEVELOPMENT OF AN ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE ACTION PLAN

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TO: Networking and Information Technology Research and Development (NITRD)

National Coordination Office (NCO), National Science Foundation

SUBJECT: Advancing Governance, Innovation, and Risk Management for Agency Use of Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

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1.0 Executive Summary

Artificial Intelligence (AI) is rapidly transforming industries, economies, and national security, making it imperative for the government, organizations, and individuals to plan with tangible and actionable items. Executive Order 14179, Safe, Secure, and Trustworthy Development and Use of Artificial Intelligence, underscores the urgency of ensuring AI advancements align with national interests, economic growth, and security considerations. Key priorities must include the development of cutting-edge semiconductor chips to power AI applications, the expansion of high-performance data centers to handle increasing computational demands, and strategies for optimizing energy consumption and efficiency to mitigate environmental impacts. Additionally, fostering responsible model development, assessing and mitigating AI-related risks, and promoting innovation and competition are essential to maintaining the U.S leadership in AI while ensuring its safe and ethical deployment. By addressing these priorities, an AI action plan can balance technological progress with national security, economic resilience, and societal well-being.

This action plan provides actionable items for the federal government and the private sector as concrete high priority policy activities to sustain and enhance America's AI dominance, and to ensure that unnecessary burdensome requirements do not hamper AI Innovation. The goal of this action plan is to solidify America's position as the leader in Ai and secure a brighter future for all Americans. This plan describes schedulable milestones at a high level to achieve in manner that may be easily readable by the government, private sector, and individuals. A tandem movement of groundswell and top-down approaches in a coordinated effort to meet in the middle will offer the most comprehensive coverage spanning across a myriad of individuals and entities while fostering an AI ecosystem of innovation, solution-development, and competitiveness to realize optimal value of AI's transformative potential. Department of Defense and National Intelligence Agencies are exempt from these actions.

2.0 Actions for the Government

2.1 Use Case Development

Agencies have published AI use cases to the public, and several published and non-published AI uses cases are in a conceptual phase. These conceptual AI use cases are opportunities, and the following recommended actions are specifically framed to move them from concept to practical implementation:

2.1.1 Prioritize AI use cases with low, medium, and high indicators in 10 days based on their value and alignment to agency mission, values, goals, and statutory requirements.

2.1.2 Conduct bi-monthly conceptual AI use case data collection requests from internal and external stakeholders of the agency to capture new conceptual AI use case within 5 days.

2.1.3 Conduct a technical feasibility study and cost benefit analysis for medium and high priority conceptual AI use cases within 45 days.

2.1.4 Develop Proof-of-Concepts (PoC) to validate concepts, capabilities, and organizational outcomes in 90 days. Hackathons with individuals and vendor challenges are encouraged within safe and secure environments on publicly available datasets.

2.1.5 Develop technology to produce large synthetic supervised and unsupervised data sets that are accessible to the public for testing AI solutions within 90 days.

2.1.6 Measure, Evaluate, and Share Progress of AI use case PoCs shared internally and to the public every 2 weeks after implementation.

2.1.7 Develop a publicly available dashboard to convey metrics, status, and aggregate data for each AI use case within 30 days.

2.1.8 Establish a cross-agency collaboration and knowledge sharing forum and a centralized repository or innovation hub to share PoC documentation and progress updates within 45 days.

2.2 Establish an AI Corps

Establishing a dedicated AI Corps will be critical to ensure an agency maintains technological leadership, effectively addressing mission-critical challenges, and navigation of the rapid evolution of artificial intelligence technologies. The AI Corps will serve as a specialized workforce within each agency that brings cutting edge expertise fostering innovation and accelerating practical adoption of AI solutions. The AI Corps should empower existing staff and procure contractor support to become proficient in AI product management, oversight, development, and security. The integration of federal staff who are familiar with nuances of federal regulation and prolific AI talent will ensure the transfer of knowledge and effective AI capabilities to enhance service delivery. By centralizing expertise, standardizing ethical and transparent practices, and promoting collaboration across sectors, the AI Corps positions in the federal government will keep pace with private-sector advancements and lead responsibly and confidently in the global AI landscape.

2.2.1 Establish an AI Corps within 80 days with at least 50 staff solely focused on artificial intelligence work throughout the agency

2.2.2 Develop a specialized hiring pathways and expedited recruitment process to attract AI talent from industry, academia, and government agencies in 60 days

2.2.3 Establish a partnership program with an accredited university within 70 days and establish internship and fellowship programs to foster ongoing talent inflow.

2.2.4 Create a structured training and certification program for data scientists, IT specialists, project and product managers and other interested staff to transition to work in AI within 80 days.

2.2.5 Invest in Career Development and Retention of AI Corps with transparent career ladders, recognition awards and professional conference attendance every fiscal year.

2.2.6 Provide competitive compensation and bonuses based on metrics including mentoring, ai utilization and results every fiscal year.

2.3 Procurement

Establishing streamlined procurement processes for AI within the federal government is crucial to accelerating innovation, reducing time-to-implementation, and ensuring responsible, efficient use resources. Agencies face complex and lengthy acquisition processes, which can also down the adoption of rapidly evolving AI and hinder responsiveness to emerging opportunities. By developing standardized guidelines, flexible contract vehicles, and clear vendor evaluation criteria based on prototyping results from hackathons or contests.

2.3.1 Establish standardized guidelines for AI procurement, including recommended language, evaluation criteria and vendor responsibilities for AI Systems within 45 days.

2.3.2 Develop a robust qualification criterion to evaluate vendor experience, reliability, security, ethics, compliance, and explainability of AI solutions within 55 days.

2.3.3 Create workshops for each procurement tests with contests using synthetic data to evaluate the technical feasibility to produce AI services or products within 60 days.

2.3.4 Establish a procurement Innovation Lab and Pilot

2.3.4.1 Develop a framework for conducting AI-focused procurement innovation labs within 30 days.

2.3.4.2 Create a plan for executing AI-focused procurement innovation labs within 50 days.

2.4 Infrastructure

Improving IT infrastructure to support AI adoption is critical for agencies to ensure effective, scalable, and secure implementation of advanced artificial intelligence solutions. Robust infrastructure – including high-performance computing, resilient cloud platforms, secure data storage, and modernized networks – is foundational for managing AI workloads, processing large datasets, and enabling real-time analytics. Without sufficient infrastructure investments, agencies risk being unable to fully leverage AI's capabilities, potentially resulting in inefficiencies, security vulnerabilities, and lost opportunities for innovation. By prioritizing infrastructure enhancements and evaluating cloud offerings federal agencies can ensure that AI applications run reliably, ethically, and securely, thereby accelerating mission effectiveness, prompting interoperability across agencies, enhancing cybersecurity, and ultimately delivering improved services and outcomes for the public.

2.4.1 Conduct assessments of existing IT infrastructure to determine readiness for AI adoption, identifying gaps in compute power, storage capacity, network capabilities, and security frameworks within 90 days.

2.4.2 Evaluate on premises and cloud hosting environments using technical and economic feasibility studies within 60 days.

2.4.3 Establish environments to foster rapid application development and prototyping of AI solutions within 45 days.

2.5 Communication and Stakeholder Engagement

Improving communication and stakeholder engagement is essential for federal agencies to build public trust, foster transparency, and ensure successful adoption of artificial intelligence solutions. Effective communication strategies enable agencies to clearly articulate their AI goals, share project outcomes, and demonstrate accountability to the public and stakeholders. Engaging stakeholders—including citizens, industry partners, academia, and internal agency personnel—ensures diverse perspectives are considered, promotes knowledge sharing, and strengthens collaboration. Moreover, proactive communication helps identify and address concerns early, particularly regarding ethics, privacy, and data security, thereby facilitating smoother implementation and greater acceptance of AI technologies.

2.5.1 Develop a communication plan about projects, goals, milestones, and outcomes through agency websites and dedicated portals within 30 days.

2.5.2 Establish a modernized platform to transfer knowledge between federal agencies and industry stakeholders to align objectives and inform policy decisions within 120 days.

2.5.3 Leverage tools such as social media, blogs, and newsletters to relay information about AI within the agency within 45 days.

2.6 Ethics, Oversight, AI Explainability, and Accountability

Establishing robust mechanisms for ethics, oversight, and accountability in AI initiatives is essential for federal agencies to ensure responsible, trustworthy, and transparent AI deployments. Clearly defined ethical standards and governance frameworks help agencies proactively identify, mitigate, and manage potential biases, privacy concerns, and unintended consequences inherent in AI technologies. By promoting transparency through explainable AI models, federal agencies build public confidence, facilitate effective oversight, and enable accountability in decision-making. Additionally, establishing dedicated oversight bodies or ethics committees supports continual evaluation and compliance, fostering a culture of responsible innovation that aligns AI implementation with core values, laws, and societal expectations. Ultimately, strong ethical governance and stakeholder engagement safeguard agency reputations, enhance service quality, and build sustainable trust with the public.

2.6.1 Mandate completion of AI Ethics training for all staff within 30 days.

2.6.2 Establish an AI ethics oversight committee to monitor adherence to ethical standards and a process for guidance for ethical challenges within 30 days.

3.0 Actions for Private Sector

3.1 Establish Grants and Tax Incentives

Establishing grants and tax incentives for AI adoption in the private sector is essential for federal agencies aiming to stimulate innovation, drive economic growth, and enhance national competitiveness in artificial intelligence. By providing targeted financial support, agencies can lower the barriers for small businesses, startups, and established companies to invest in advanced AI infrastructure, workforce development, and research initiatives. Grants and tax incentives enable companies, especially small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs), to allocate resources toward developing innovative solutions, expanding infrastructure capabilities, and accelerating deployment of ethical and responsible AI technologies. This approach not only promotes faster technological advancement but also strengthens public-private collaboration, creates new jobs, and maintains the United States' position as a global leader in AI.

3.1.1 Create a grants program for AI small businesses and corporations for infrastructure, cybersecurity, workforce development, and research within 120 days.

3.1.2 Implement tax incentives to businesses who utilize and work in the advancement of AI within 120 days.

3.2 Scholarships and Education

Establishing federal scholarships, AI university, and educational grants focused on AI is critical to building a robust talent pipeline and ensuring a highly skilled workforce capable of driving AI innovation in the private sector. By funding education and training programs specifically tailored to artificial intelligence, data science, computer science, and related fields, federal agencies can help address significant workforce skill gaps, accelerate adoption of advanced technologies, and ensure American competitiveness globally. Scholarships and grants empower individuals, particularly from underrepresented communities, to pursue specialized education and contribute actively to the AI economy. This initiative strengthens public-private collaboration, promotes economic mobility, and ensures sustained innovation by cultivating a diverse, highly skilled workforce prepared for the evolving technological landscape.

3.2.1 Create federal scholarships and grants for individuals who excel in data, computer science, and math to further their education and contribute to artificial intelligence within 120 days.

3.2.2 Enhance school curriculums to include AI as early as junior high school or intermediate school within 230 days.

3.2.3 Create a university funded by the federal government solely dedicated to AI education and free to students and enrollment with strict academic requirements within 2 fiscal years.

3.3 Financing to Build AI Infrastructure

Establishing federal financing programs, such as low-interest or no-interest loans for private-sector investment in AI infrastructure like decentralized data centers, is critical to accelerating nationwide AI adoption. By reducing financial barriers, federal agencies can incentivize private companies—especially small businesses and startups—to develop robust, secure, and efficient infrastructure capable of handling the significant computational and storage demands of AI applications. Strategic financing supports the creation of modernized, energy-efficient data centers and computational facilities, thereby enhancing operational resilience, reducing environmental impacts, and promoting sustainable AI practices. Ultimately, targeted financial assistance encourages widespread private-sector participation, fosters economic growth, and solidifies U.S. technological leadership.

3.3.1 Provide low or no interest loans to businesses who renovate buildings to be used for decentralized data centers to process AI data and compute power within 60 days.

3.3.2 Provide research grants to universities to study ways to offset energy utilization of AI within 60 days.

In conclusion, implementing a comprehensive AI action plan through focused initiatives such as establishing an AI Corps, streamlining acquisitions and procurement, enhancing IT infrastructure, improving communication and stakeholder engagement, and providing grants and educational incentives to the private sector, positions the federal government to lead confidently in the era of artificial intelligence. These strategic efforts will ensure responsible, ethical, and effective adoption of AI technologies, fostering innovation, economic growth, and national security, while also promoting transparency and public trust. By proactively addressing these foundational areas, federal agencies and the private sector can maximize AI's benefits for society, drive American competitiveness, and ultimately enhance service delivery and citizen experiences.